Time, distance & everyday connections

Hybrid study & handwriting workbook

29.10.2026

Read a pattern, use it in context, try without help, then write.

69 expressions / 8 topics

01 / Classes, work & breaks
上课 shàng kè · 下课 xià kè

02 / Say the time
两点 liǎng diǎn · 两点零二 liǎng diǎn líng èr

03 / From … to …
从 cóng · 到 dào

04 / Routes & distance
地方 dìfang · 离 lí

05 / People around you
同 tóng · 同学 tóngxué

06 / Look closely, hear the difference
门 mén · 问 wèn

07 / Objects, classifiers & keys
桌子 zhuōzi · 椅子 yǐzi

08 / Two extra board words
萝卜 luóbo · 罗汉果 luóhànguǒ

Based on eleven classroom photographs. Added examples are labelled. Same lesson: chinese-os-study.gizmuf.chatgpt.site/?course=intensive&lesson=8

Classes, work & breaks

上课 / 下课 describe starting or attending class and finishing it; 上班 / 下班 concern work. 有课 means having a class scheduled. 休息 means resting. The board's class interval is 08:40–12:00; the break is 12:00–13:00.

上课

shàng kè

attend / start class

下课

xià kè

finish class

上班

shàng bān

go to / start work

下班

xià bān

finish work

有课

yǒu kè

have classes

课

kè

lesson / class

班

bān

class group / work shift

休息

xiūxi

rest / take a break

检查

jiǎnchá

check / inspect

我们下课了。

Wǒmen xià kè le.

We have finished class.

Additional practice example

Say the time

两点 is two o'clock; use 两 for the hour two. 零 marks the empty tens position in 两点零二 / 两点零五. 一刻 is fifteen minutes; 半 is half an hour. At 2:45, 两点四十五分, 两点三刻 and 差一刻三点 describe the same time. In 差…三点, 三点 is the upcoming hour, not the current one.

两点

liǎng diǎn

two o'clock

两点零二

liǎng diǎn líng èr

2:02

两点零五

liǎng diǎn líng wǔ

2:05

两点十五分

liǎng diǎn shíwǔ fēn

2:15 (fifteen minutes past two)

两点一刻

liǎng diǎn yí kè

a quarter past two

两点半

liǎng diǎn bàn

half past two

两点四十五分

liǎng diǎn sìshíwǔ fēn

2:45 (forty-five minutes past two)

两点三刻

liǎng diǎn sān kè

2:45 (three quarters past two)

两点五十五分

liǎng diǎn wǔshíwǔ fēn

2:55 (fifty-five minutes past two)

差一刻三点

chà yí kè sān diǎn

a quarter to three

一刻是十五分钟。

Yí kè shì shíwǔ fēnzhōng.

A quarter of an hour is fifteen minutes.

Additional practice example

Say the time / 2

两点 is two o’clock; use 两 for the hour two. 零 marks the empty tens position in 两点零二 / 两点零五. 一刻 is fifteen minutes; 半 is half an hour. At 2:45, 两点四十五分, 两点三刻 and 差一刻三点 describe the same time. In 差…三点, 三点 is the upcoming hour, not the current one.

差五分三点

chà wǔ fēn sān diǎn

five to three

一刻

yí kè

a quarter of an hour

分钟

fēnzhōng

minute (duration)

下午一点

xiàwǔ yì diǎn

one in the afternoon

点

diǎn

o’clock (here)

半

bàn

half

零

líng

zero

一刻是十五分钟。

Yí kè shì shíwǔ fēnzhōng.

A quarter of an hour is fifteen minutes.

Additional practice example

From ... to ...

从...到... works for time and for a route. Put both endpoints before the action: 我们从星期一到星期五上班. In the board phrase 是（从）星期一到星期五, brackets show an optional 从 after 是; do not treat that fragment as a complete sentence without context.

从

cóng

from

到

dào

to / until / arrive

星期一

xīngqīyī

Monday

星期五

xīngqīwǔ

Friday

时间

shíjiān

time

我们从星期一到星期五上班。

Wǒmen cóng xīngqīyī dào xīngqīwǔ shàng bān.

We work from Monday to Friday.

Additional practice example

Routes & distance

从你家到学校 describes endpoints; 我家离学校很近 describes distance between places. 离 is not a replacement for 从 in every sentence. The board heading 世界上最远的距离 is a noun phrase, not a completed quotation; no missing continuation or author is supplied.

地方
dìfang
place

离
lí
away from (distance marker)

远
yuǎn
far

近
jìn
near

学校
xuéxiào
school

家
jiā
home / family

世界
shìjiè
world

距离
jùlí
distance

最远
zuì yuǎn
farthest

世界上最远的距离
shìjiè shàng zuì yuǎn de jùlí
the greatest distance in the world (a heading)

我家离学校很近。
Wǒ jiā lí xuéxiào hěn jìn.
My home is near the school.
From the classroom board; numeric times written out.

People around you

The shared 同 suggests something in common, but learn each whole word: 同屋 roommate, 同桌 deskmate, 同事 colleague. 同意 means agree. 有空 uses kòng for free time; 有事 can mean being busy or having a matter to discuss, depending on context.

同

tóng

same / together

同学

tóngxué

classmate / fellow student

同班同学

tóngbān tóngxué

classmate in the same class group

同屋

tóngwū

roommate

同桌

tóngzhuō

deskmate

同事

tóngshì

colleague

同意

tóngyì

agree

不同意

bù tóngyì

disagree

有事

yǒu shì

have something to do / have a matter to discuss

有空

yǒu kòng

have free time

他是我的同桌。

Tā shì wǒ de tóngzhuō.

He is my deskmate.

Additional practice example

Look closely, hear the difference

门, 问, 间 and 闻 share a visible outer shape; 同 has a different enclosure. These are shape observations, not a claim about historical origin. Read 问 wèn (ask) and 闻 wén (smell) distinctly. 间 is jiān in 房间 and 时间; some other words use jiàn.

门

mén

door / gate

问

wèn

ask

间

jiān

room / between (here)

闻

wén

smell / hear of

我想问一个问题。

Wǒ xiǎng wèn yí ge wèntí.

I would like to ask a question.

Additional practice example

Objects, classifiers & keys

Use 一张 for 桌子, 地图 and 纸; 一把 for 椅子 and 钥匙. The classroom sentence 我钥匙在你车里 colloquially omits 的; practise the clear version 我的钥匙在你车里 too. 钥匙 is yàoshi, with neutral shi. The board joke 要死 yàosǐ means “going to die” and is different text and meaning, not a translation of “my keys”.

桌子

zhuōzi

table / desk

椅子

yǐzi

chair

地图

dìtú

map

纸

zhǐ

paper

钥匙

yàoshi

key

一张

yì zhāng

one (classifier for flat things)

一把

yì bǎ

one (classifier for handled objects)

张

zhāng

classifier for flat things

把

bǎ

classifier for handled objects

车

chē

vehicle / car

请给我一张纸。

Qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng zhǐ.

Please give me a sheet of paper.

Additional practice example

Objects, classifiers & keys / 2

Use 一张 for 桌子, 地图 and 纸; 一把 for 椅子 and 钥匙. The classroom sentence 我钥匙在你车里 colloquially omits 的; practise the clear version 我的钥匙在你车里 too. 钥匙 is yàoshi, with neutral shi. The board joke 要死 yàosǐ means “going to die” and is different text and meaning, not a translation of “my keys”.

里

lǐ

inside

给

gěi

give / to

请给我一张纸。

Qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng zhǐ.

Please give me a sheet of paper.

Additional practice example

Two extra board words

萝卜 (radish) and 罗汉果 (monk fruit) appear separately on the board. Learn them as whole words. Additional sentences here practise ordinary identification and shopping.

萝卜

luóbo

radish

罗汉果

luóhànguǒ

monk fruit

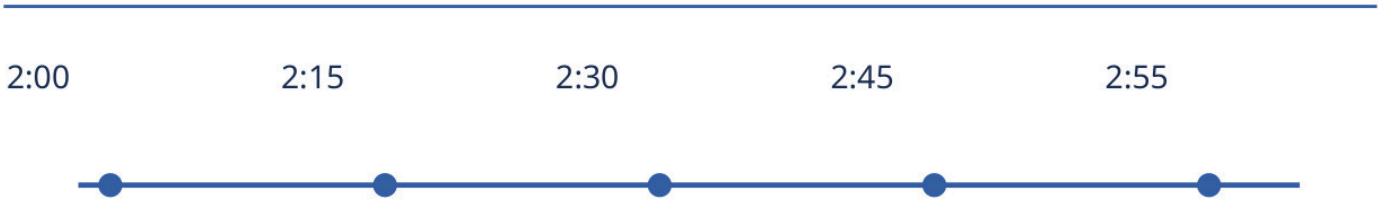
我想买萝卜。

Wǒ xiǎng mǎi luóbo.

I would like to buy radishes.

Additional practice example

One hour, several ways to say it



两点	两点一刻	两点半	两点三刻	差五分三点
liǎng diǎn	liǎng diǎn yí kè	liǎng diǎn bàn	liǎng diǎn sān kè	chà wǔ fēn sān diǎn
two o'clock	a quarter past two	half past two	2:45 (three quarters past two)	five to three

一刻是十五分钟。

Yí kè shì shíwǔ fēnzhōng.

A quarter of an hour is fifteen minutes.

Additional practice example

两点四十五分，也可以说差一刻三点。

Liǎng diǎn sìshíwǔ fēn, yě kěyǐ shuō chà yí kè sān diǎn.

For 2:45, you can also say a quarter to three.

Additional practice example

两点五十五分，也可以说差五分三点。

Liǎng diǎn wǔshíwǔ fēn, yě kěyǐ shuō chà wǔ fēn sān diǎn.

For 2:55, you can also say five to three.

Additional practice example

Read first - without pinyin

Describe the schedule, the route and the people. Cover the answers until you finish.

1

我们从星期一到星期五有课。

我们从八点四十分到十二点上课。

我们从十二点到下午一点休息。

2

从你家到学校远吗?

从我家到学校很近。

我家离学校很近。

3

他是我的同桌。

她是我的同事。

我的钥匙在你车里。

Recall & speak

1. Say 2:02, 2:15, 2:30, 2:45 and 2:55. Give two alternatives for 2:45.

2. State the class interval 08:40-12:00 and break 12:00-13:00.

3. Ask if it is far from home to school. Answer that your home is near school.

Recall & speak

4. Say who your deskmate and roommate are. Agree, then disagree.

5. Ask for a sheet of paper and a map. Name the classifier for a chair and a key.

6. Distinguish ask from smell by tone. Say where your keys are.

Answers - open after trying

1. Say 2:02, 2:15, 2:30, 2:45 and 2:55. Give two alternatives for 2:45.

两点零二 liǎng diǎn líng èr
2:02

两点一刻 liǎng diǎn yí kè
a quarter past two

两点半 liǎng diǎn bàn
half past two

两点三刻 liǎng diǎn sān kè
2:45 (three quarters past two)

差一刻三点 chà yí kè sān diǎn
a quarter to three

差五分三点 chà wǔ fēn sān diǎn
five to three

2. State the class interval 08:40-12:00 and break 12:00-13:00.

我们从八点四十分到十二点上课。 Wǒmen cóng bā diǎn sìshí fēn dào shí'èr diǎn shàng kè.
We have class from 8:40 to 12:00.

我们从十二点到下午一点休息。 Wǒmen cóng shí'èr diǎn dào xiàwǔ yì diǎn xiūxi.
We take a break from noon to one in the afternoon.

Answers - open after trying

3. Ask if it is far from home to school. Answer that your home is near school.

从你家到学校远吗？ Cóng nǐ jiā dào xuéxiào yuǎn ma?
Is it far from your home to school?

我家离学校很近。 Wǒ jiā lí xuéxiào hěn jìn.
My home is near the school.

4. Say who your deskmate and roommate are. Agree, then disagree.

他是我的同桌。 Tā shì wǒ de tóngzhuō.
He is my deskmate.

她是我的同屋。 Tā shì wǒ de tóngwū.
She is my roommate.

我同意。 Wǒ tóngyì.
I agree.

我不同意。 Wǒ bù tóngyì.
I disagree.

Answers - open after trying

5. Ask for a sheet of paper and a map. Name the classifier for a chair and a key.

请给我一张纸。 Qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng zhǐ.
Please give me a sheet of paper.

请给我一张地图。 Qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng dìtú.
Please give me a map.

这是一把钥匙。 Zhè shì yì bǎ yàoshi.
This is a key.

6. Distinguish ask from smell by tone. Say where your keys are.

问 wèn
ask

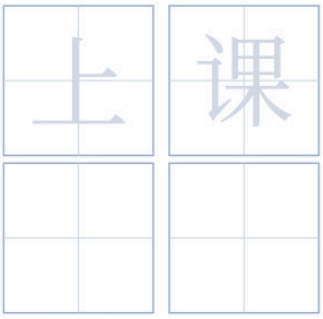
闻 wén
smell / hear of

我的钥匙在你车里。 Wǒ de yàoshi zài nǐ chē lǐ.
My keys are in your car.

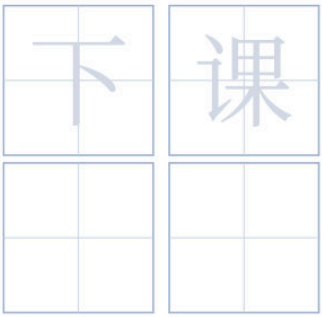
Trace, then write from memory

Read the whole expression with its meaning. Pale models are for tracing; the white row is for recall.

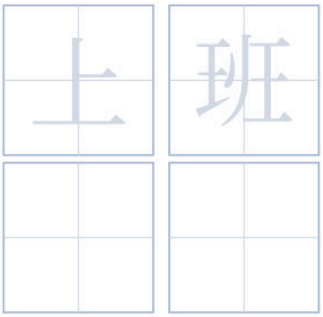
上课 shàng kè · attend / start class



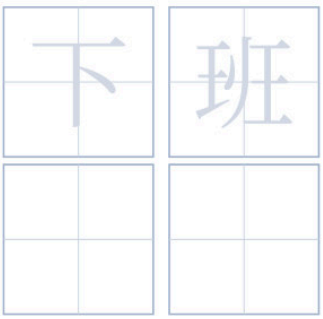
下课 xià kè · finish class



上班 shàng bān · go to / start work



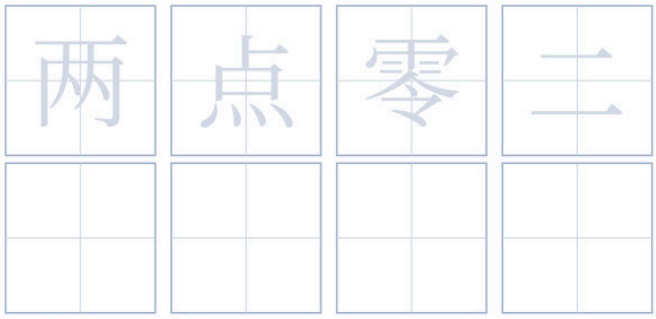
下班 xià bān · finish work



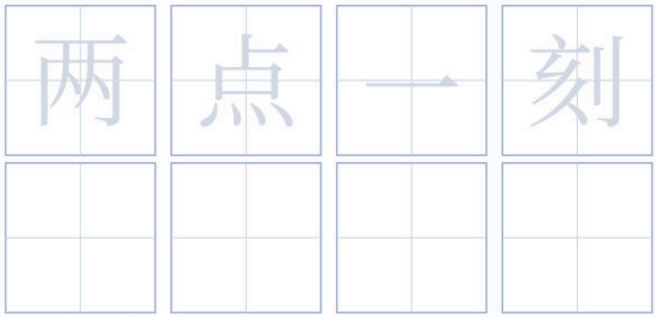
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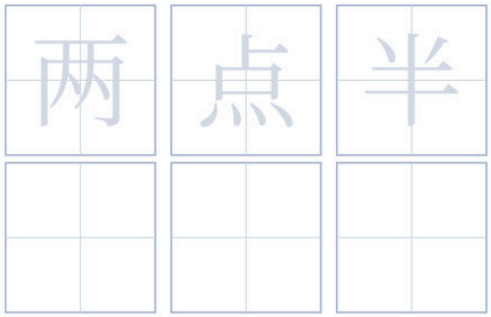
两点零二 liǎng diǎn líng èr · 2:02



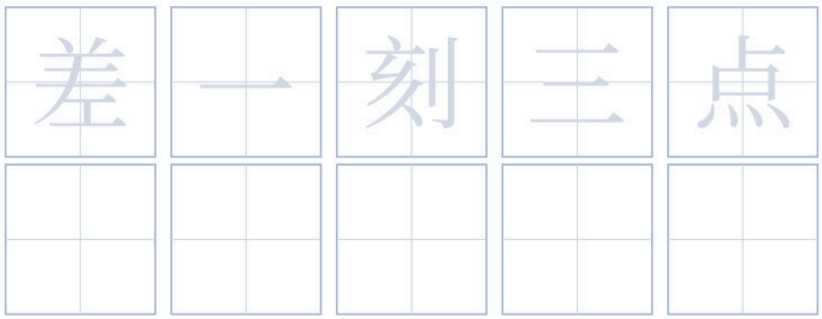
两点一刻 liǎng diǎn yí kè · a quarter past two



两点半 liǎng diǎn bàn · half past two



差一刻三点 chà yí kè sān diǎn · a quarter to three



Trace, then write from memory

Read the whole expression with its meaning. Pale models are for tracing; the white row is for recall.

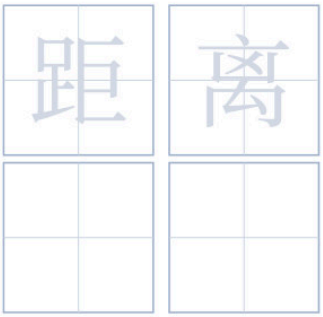
从 cóng · from



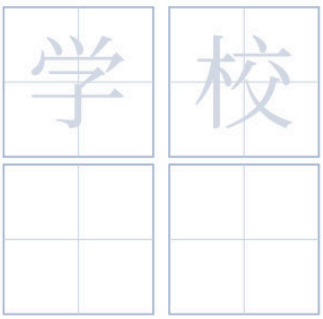
到 dào · to / until / arrive



距离 jùlí · distance



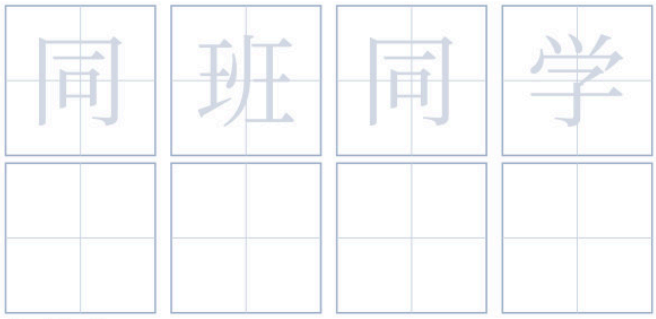
学校 xuéxiào · school



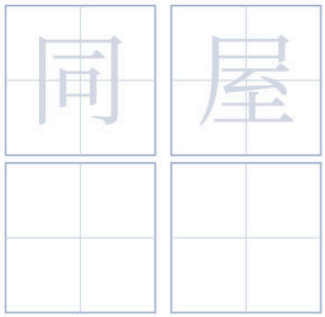
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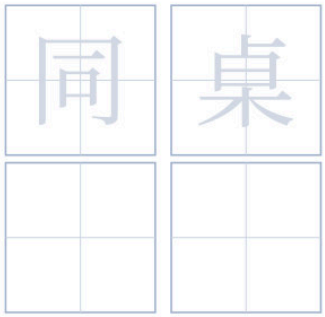
同班同学 tóngbān tóngxué · classmate in the same class group



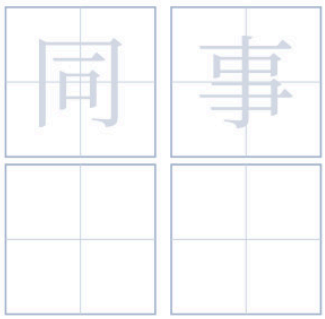
同屋 tóngwū · roommate



同桌 tóngzhuō · deskmate



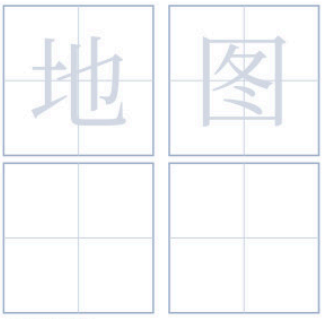
同事 tóngshì · colleague



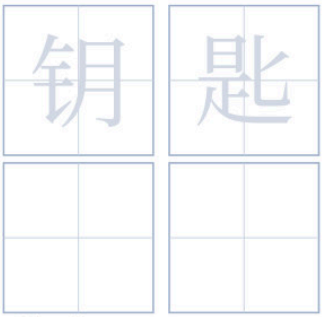
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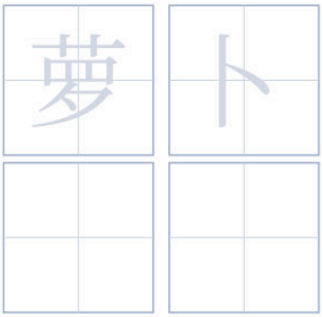
地图 dìtú · map



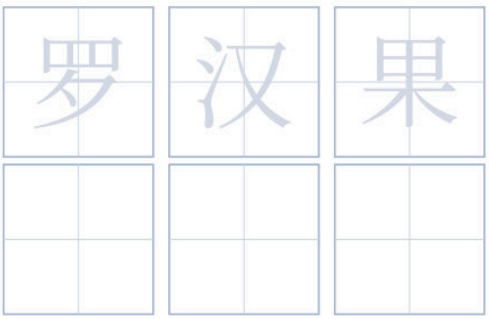
钥匙 yàoshi · key



萝卜 luóbo · radish



罗汉果 luóhànguǒ · monk fruit

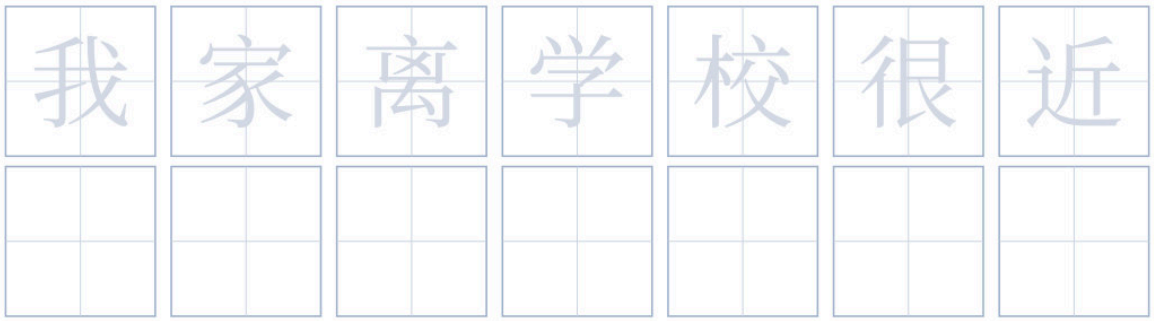


Trace, then write from memory

我家离学校很近。

Wǒ jiā lí xuéxiào hěn jìn.

My home is near the school.



Trace, then write from memory

我的钥匙在你车里。

Wǒ de yàoshi zài nǐ chē lǐ.

My keys are in your car.

